

Ireland

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	5.44 m
GDP	EUR 602 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	144 k
Electricity price	255.2 EUR/MWh
Renewables	41.3%
Live hyperscaler regions	2

2 What is structurally different

- Grid isolation. The national grid is an electrical island or nearly so (weak or single interconnection). The April 2025 Iberian blackout and Cyprus/Malta interconnector outages show the failure mode. Every site needs on-site generation and storage sized for multi-day ride-through, and the PUE and facility CAPEX assumptions should be revisited upward once site studies exist.
- Expensive power (255 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.

3 Capacity

Servers	2,026 (CPU 1,338 / GPU 125 / storage 563)
IT critical load	3.5 MW
Facility design load	5.3 MW
Sites	3 (by capacity 1, floor 3)
Average per site	1.8 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 131 m
OPEX	EUR 16 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Dublin	Primary civil cloud	41%	2.2	OGCIO/Backweston estate, INEX; EirGrid connection moratorium to ~2028 is binding.

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Cork	Sovereign secondary	27%	1.4	Atlantic cable landings (Kinsale, Amstie), Celtic Interconnector.
Galway - Limerick / West	Government / continuity	23%	1.2	Wind surplus, AEC-1 landing (Killala).
Midlands / Athlone	Strategic reserve	10%	0.5	Post-peat land and grid; reserve/expansion.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Public Service ICT Strategy and OGCI0 cloud-first policy; no sovereignty carve-out
Cloud certification	No national scheme; ISO 27001
Data classification	Official Secrets Act; departmental classification rather than a single statutory ladder
Procurement route	Office of Government Procurement (OGP)

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. Highest exposure in the EU-27: AWS eu-west-1 and Azure North Europe are both anchored in Dublin and government is a direct consumer under a cloud-first policy with no sovereignty carve-out

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	No sovereign cloud; OGCI0 Build to Share + Government Cloud Network + Backweston government DCs; cloud-first Advice Note; Digital Decade 2025 report flags DC grid limits
Maturity	pilot
Digital identity	MyGovID (Public Services Card)
Interconnection	INEX Dublin/Cork; Atlantic landings Killala Kinsale Cork

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	0.9	EUR 17 m	13%	no
2	Security and defense	1.2	EUR 30 m	35%	no
3	State record	1.0	EUR 26 m	55%	no
4	Elective	2.2	EUR 59 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 17 m** for 0.9 MW, 13% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Negligible seismic; Atlantic storm/coastal and river floods; GRID IS BINDING: EirGrid Dublin DC connection moratorium to ~2028, DCs ~21% of national electricity; most expensive EU power; single UK gas pipeline until Celtic Interconnector (~2027); neutral non-NATO; subsea cable vulnerability